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Cognitive Science 128: Cognitive Engineering

University of California, Merced

Spring 2026, March 13

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Revised Proposal – Skill Swap / Bartering App

People today have many useful skills and resources, but there are limited ways to exchange those skills without using money. This can lead to missed opportunities for people who need services but cannot afford them. Many existing platforms such as Fiverr or TaskRabbit require users to pay for services, which can be difficult for students or people with limited budgets. Our project proposes an application that allows users to exchange skills and services directly with one another instead of paying money.

The idea of the app is simple: users create profiles that list the skills or services they can offer and the skills they are looking for. The platform will then match users with compatible partners who may benefit from exchanging services. For example, a college student who is good at graphic design but needs help with math tutoring could match with someone who offers tutoring but needs design help. This type of exchange allows both users to benefit from each other's abilities without needing to pay for services.

To make this system work effectively, the app would include several important features. First, there would be a matching system that connects users based on the skills they offer, the skills they need, and possibly their location or availability. This would help ensure that users are matched with people who have compatible needs and are within reach. Second, the platform would include an agreement tool where both users can define the terms of the exchange before starting. This helps clarify expectations and prevent misunderstandings.

Trust and fairness are also important aspects of the platform. To address this, the app would include a reputation system where users can rate and review each other after completing a trade. Each profile would display previous exchanges, ratings, and reviews so that users can see if someone is reliable before agreeing to trade services. In addition, users may be able to upload examples of their work or describe their experience level in a skill so that others can better judge their ability.

Another important improvement to the system would involve safety and dispute resolution. The platform could include identity verification options (such as verifying a school email for students), reporting tools, and moderation support if a dispute occurs between users. This would help reduce scams or unfair exchanges and make users feel more comfortable trading skills with people they do not know personally.

The target users for this application include college students, freelancers, and members of local communities who often need services such as tutoring, tech help, design work, photography, or language practice but may not always have the money to pay for them. By allowing users to exchange services instead of paying for them, the platform encourages collaboration and makes services more accessible.

To better understand the needs of potential users, our team plans to conduct interviews and gather feedback. Questions such as “Have you ever traded skills informally?”, “What would make you trust someone enough to exchange services?”, and “How do you decide if a trade is fair?” can help guide the design of the platform. This feedback will help us understand what features are most important for building trust and usability.

There are already a few platforms that involve skill sharing, such as Simbi, TimeBanks, and Skillshare. Simbi allows users to exchange services using virtual credits, while TimeBanks operate on a system where one hour of service equals one hour of credit. Skillshare focuses mainly on teaching through video courses. Our proposed app differs slightly because it focuses on direct skill exchanges between individuals and includes features such as matching systems, negotiation tools, and agreement features to help organize fair trades.

Overall, the goal of this project is to explore how a platform for exchanging skills could improve access to services while building stronger community connections. By allowing people to share their

abilities and help one another, the application could provide a practical and collaborative alternative to traditional paid service platforms.